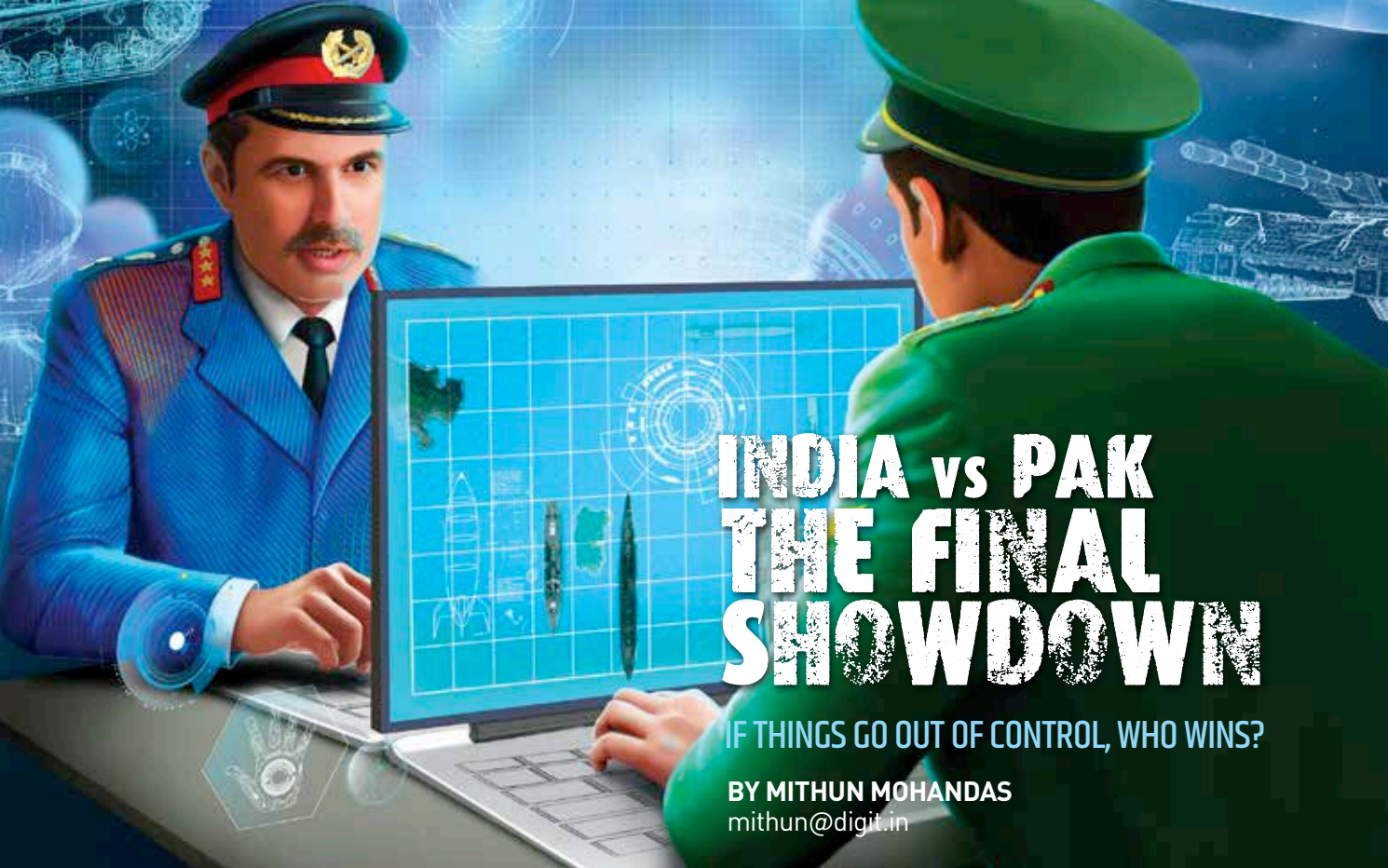




INDIA vs PAK THE FINAL SHOWDOWN

IF THINGS GO OUT OF CONTROL, WHO WINS?

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Tensions have always been high with our neighbours. Pakistan to the east and China to the north. And we've kept up with the camaraderie for as long as the border lines have been drawn. And we've redrawn those lines with the blood of our soldiers over the years. We've even fought wars with each other ever since 1947, some we've won, some our neighbours have won and some were inconclusive. The current atmosphere seems to be slowly veering towards another conflict but it's all hype. Our armies have performed such acts of pre-emptive defence for decades, it's just that the recent ones are getting a little too much of the limelight. But that doesn't stop us from wondering...

What if?

What if we do go to war with Pakistan in this day and age? Will it ever go as far as nuking each other out? And let's say if it ever does come to that, who comes out on top?

MILITARY MIGHT

If we are to stand toe to toe, then it should come as no surprise that India is way ahead of Pakistan when it comes to numbers. We have 1.325 million active servicemen while Pakistan has 0.620

million. And if we count our reserve forces then the number climbs to an astounding 3.5 million soldiers ready to answer the call, outnumbering Pakistan by 3-to-1. However, war isn't just about numbers. The brave 300 spartans held out against the massive Persian army (we're aware the 300 had a lot of help from the other city states) for seven days because they made the best use of local terrain. Similar examples are littered across the history pages. Rather than delving that deep let us compare the armed forces of the two nations briefly.

NAVAL

India, given its vast coastline, has historically paid a lot of attention towards improving its naval might. Being one of the few blue-water navies in the world, we even have our own nuclear propelled submarine. If we are to compare the best vessels from either navies i.e. the Indian Navy's Kolkata Class and Pakistani Navy's Zulfiqar Class then the Zulfiqar is at a disadvantage. Everything from our sensor systems, electronic warfare systems and armament are way ahead of what the Zulfiqar has to offer. While the main cannons on both ships are 76mm, the AK-630 Close-in-Weapon-System on the Kolkata Class

ships are much superior to the Chinese made Type 730B. Moreover, the Kolkata Class is capable of carrying 16 BrahMos missiles which are one of the best in class missile systems. Let's just say that given our naval superiority, Pakistan has its work cut out.

AIRFORCE

In a similar vein, the Indian Air Force is way superior in terms of numbers in every class of aircraft. Our Sukhoi Su-30MKI is way better than Pakistan's JF-17 Thunder which happens to be a light-weight multi-role combat aircraft. However, we lack pilots and that's a well publicised issue. Moreover, we've lost over 170 pilots in MiG-21s and they've earned the moniker of "flying coffins". Our pilot-to-cockpit ratio is 0.81 while that of Pakistan is 2.5:1. Simply put, we can't deploy our full force. Lastly, we are actively developing fifth-generation fighters while there have been no such developments in the PAF. But hey, they can always count on China to help them out.

ARMY

The Indian Army has proved its mettle time and time again in three wars and has come out on top every time. The